



Fwd: Vision & Feature Overview: CM&A Church Management System

T.X. Ho <tx.ho99@gmail.com>
To: Simon Lieu <lieu.thanh.chi@gmail.com>
Cc: CoHo redemptionpoint <pastorbumble@gmail.com>, "Peter Doan - Vietnamese District, C&MA" <pdoan.vndistrict@gmail.com>

Hello all,

I love the goal of going simple and hiding complexity. Chi's suggestion of using both ChMeetings and ChurchCM makes sense. The majority of churches can use ChurchCM simplified front end.

I propose that we present to DEXCOM with [this proposal](#). Would you please review and make changes as you see fit? I just guessed the cost. Pastor Bumble, please provide your inputs on a live discussion is needed, we will set up one.

Thank you and God Bless,
Truong

On Fri, Feb 6, 2026 at 11:21 AM Simon Lieu <lieu.thanh.chi@gmail.com> wrote:
Hello Pastor Bumble,
Thank you for setting up the JAX Church account. I received it and will take a look.

To clarify a few points about ChurchCM and the project behind it:
ChurchCM.com is currently a **demo based on my research and prior experience**, especially from working with MS Duc and the IT team at Orange Church. The existing features reflect our CRM/ERP vision.
ChurchCM is **not related to ChurchCRM.io**, and the similar naming is purely coincidental. This project was built by combining several earlier pilot projects I worked on, including:

- A Kids Check-in system
- A local church management tool
- A team and event management system

That said, I fully agree with your point about open source and sustainability. Since my goal is to help as many churches as possible, I'm open to releasing ChurchCM under the MIT license. An important thing to me is that the system is useful and responsibly maintained.

Rather than positioning ChurchCM as a replacement for ChMeetings, my proposal is to make **ChurchCM work alongside ChMeetings**, for example:

- A push/sync system to update people and groups into ChMeetings
- Using ChMeetings forms while centralizing data and workflows in ChurchCM
- Run ChurchCM as a per-church system, allowing HG or the District to push data to local churches and retrieve reports as needed
- A single API-key-based connection between ChMeetings and ChurchCM, which can be disabled at any time by removing the key

From an operations standpoint, **deployment and reset are simple**. The system is designed so a church instance can be deployed or reset with essentially one action. I agree that GH/District ownership matters. Pastor Bumble could oversee the system at a high level, and I'd be happy to support it as the main developer if that's helpful.

Happy to discuss this further and adjust direction based on what best serves the churches.

P.S. I spoke with MS Phat today, and he's happy for JAX Church to try out the ChMeetings system.

Blessings,
Simon Lieu
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Cell: 714-261-3167 | me@simonlieu.com
<https://www.simonlieu.com>

On Fri, Feb 6, 2026 at 10:34 AM CoHo redemptionpoint <pastorbumble@gmail.com> wrote:
Hello Simon and Thay Truong,

I created the Sample Church with Thay Truong as admin and added Peter and 2 of my accounts into it. I also created the JAX Church with Simon as the admin and added MS Phat into it in our DB). Please check your email for login credentials, then you can take it for a spin.

Chmeetings People			
Search by name, email or m			
Send All People: Text Email Push Notification Export More Actions			
NAME	EMAIL	MOBILE	HOME PHONE
☐ Bumble	Bumble.Ho@sonlife.com	(714) 555-1212	
☐ Bryan, Kobe	pdoan.vndistrict@gmail.com	(714) 290-8871	
☐ Doan, Peter Nguyen	PastorBumble@gmail.com	(714) 402-2702	
☐ Ho, Bumble Nghiep	tx.ho99@gmail.com	(925) 336-0863	(777) 777-4777
☐ Ho, TX			

But as I thought about what we talked about yesterday, I think a multi-tenant CRM/ERP-like system, such as ChMeetings, may be too complex for the church to buy in. Simon's <https://Ch> was to get the church ready for the District Annual Report as the MVP we are looking for. The only serious question I would like to ask Simon is this:

On the homepage of <https://ChurchCM.com>, in the "Support Our Mission" section, it says donations support "the continued development and maintenance of this open-source project." He source project at <https://github.com/ChurchCRM/CRM> ?

That project has an MIT license, so all you need to do is make your repository open to the public, and then we can consider it as a viable project for the small churches in the District. For fork could be containerized with Docker and deployed on AWS/DigitalOcean, and the District might be able to pay you \$15-\$30/month per church for backups, SSL certificates, maintain Source community behind it would shift the risk of the District having too much technical debt from a lone developer to a much less risky trajectory.

I would propose that the option of using your fork of ChurchCRM would be a superior alternative to getting our churches on ChMeetings.com - The multi-tenant ERP-like system should be constantly have multiple systems involved with a similar set of people in the CRM database).

What do you think?

-Bumble

On Thu, Feb 5, 2026 at 4:14 PM Peter Doan - Vietnamese District, C&MA <pdoan.vndistrict@gmail.com> wrote:
Hello everyone,

Just a quick note — I'll be at my daughter's music lesson during the meeting, so I won't be able to talk much, but I'll be listening in.

From the District side, my biggest concern right now is getting our data clean and aligned between CHMeetings and the C&MA CMS that we're required to maintain.

We're seeing inconsistencies not only in legal names vs. preferred/Vietnamese names and titles, but even in church names between CMS, our District directory, and the church's Article systems, it slows everything down — credential tracking, delegate verification, reporting, and overall administrative clarity.

I've been updating CMS with each set of DExCom minutes as they come out. But going back and cleaning up all the historical raw entries across both systems would be a long, manual task we should probably define it clearly and assign paid administrative help so it gets done properly and doesn't drag on indefinitely.

We already have a structured format in the spreadsheet (Legal Name as Last, Middle, First, with a separate Badge/Nickname field). The structure itself isn't the issue — it's making sure the data is consistent across CMS.

Personally, I lean toward using CHMeetings as the operational backbone since it already handles membership, communication, and giving. I also know Pastor Bumble has direct communication on our end — like distinguishing official church names alongside Vietnamese names — we may be able to request adjustments within the existing platform. Keeping member and financial records accurate and reduce duplication on the District side.

If we do move toward building anything custom, I would also want us to be clear about long-term ownership, documentation, support, and continuity so that whatever we implement remains sustainable.

I'm not opposed to building something if there's a true District-level need. I just don't want us adding another layer before the foundation is solid. If there's a better solution for cleaning up the data, I'm open to it.

That's what I see from the day to day operations side.



On Thu, Feb 5, 2026 at 12:37 PM Peter Doan - Vietnamese District, C&MA <pdoan.vndistrict@gmail.com> wrote:
Hello All, Just in case zoom didn't send you an invite, here it is below:

VN District of the C&MA is inviting you to a scheduled Zoom meeting.

Topic: VN District Church Management System
Time: Feb 5, 2026 05:00 PM Pacific Time (US and Canada)
Join Zoom Meeting
<https://us06web.zoom.us/j/7144918007?omn=89076435651>

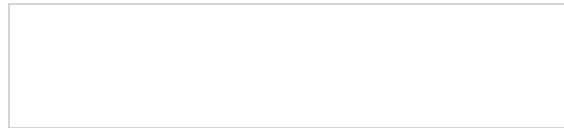
View meeting insights with Zoom AI Companion
<https://us06web.zoom.us/join/edl?muid=dd786537-5c01-474c-b3fd-55c552668b6d>

Meeting ID: 714 491 8007

One tap mobile
+16699006833,,7144918007# US (San Jose)
+166944449171,,7144918007# US

Join by SIP
• [7144918007@zoomcrc.com](tel:7144918007@zoomcrc.com)

Join instructions
<https://us06web.zoom.us/join/7144918007?signature=13YcjDXal4eek5Mi7Urfb78kyxwZPvsGwBB54PZEsCA>



On Tue, Feb 3, 2026 at 6:57 PM T.X. Ho <tx.ho99@gmail.com> wrote:
Dear all,

I spoke with Pastor Peter about sharing a brief overview of his needs from GH's perspective so Chi can incorporate that context and provide a more complete view of the gaps.

For Thursday's meeting, let's align on the project charter as Pastor Bumble suggested, including:

- **Scope** of the initiative
- **Resources required** (manpower and funding)
- **Proposed timeframe**

After we align internally, I'd like to present the charter to DEXCOM to gather input and secure approval before we formally kick off the project.

See you all on Thursday.

Blessings,
Truong

Sent from my iPhone

On Feb 3, 2026, at 4:44 PM, CoHo redemptionpoint <PastorBumble@gmail.com> wrote:

Hello Pastor Peter,

Could you please set up a Zoom Meeting for us this Thursday, February 5, 2026, from 5:00 to 6:00 PM Pacific Time to meet on the project we are discussing here. Please e

I was about to use my Zoom account, only to discover that my Zoom Account is no longer active. I am in the process of changing my Zoom from my former workplace to a n non-profit discount verification to finish.

Thanks,

-Bumble

On Wed, Jan 28, 2026 at 2:27 PM Simon Lieu <lieu.thanh.chi@gmail.com> wrote:

Hello Thay Truong, Pastor Bumble, and Pastor Peter,

Thank you, the meeting time on Thursday, February 5, 2026, from 5:00–6:00 PM Pacific works well for me. Please feel free to lock it in.

Thank you also, Pastor Bumble, for the guidance and the detailed pointers on ChMeetings. I'll review the website, knowledge base, and release notes ahead of time so I c productive as possible.

Looking forward to the discussion and collaborating together.

Blessings,

Simon Lieu

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Cell: 714-261-3167 | me@simonlieu.com

<https://www.simonlieu.com>

On Wed, Jan 28, 2026 at 1:50 PM Peter Doan - Vietnamese District, C&MA <pdoan.vndistrict@gmail.com> wrote:

Sorry everyone. If I meet for that time, I would only be available for about 25 mins from 5:00-5:25 PM. But for the sake of taking the next steps, I think we should keep that.



On Wed, Jan 28, 2026 at 1:00 PM CoHo redemptionpoint <pastorbumble@gmail.com> wrote:

Hi Thay Truong, Pastor Peter, and Simon,

Thank you, Thay Truong. I agree that it has been a really encouraging and constructive dialogue. Thank God for the collaboration. **Thursday, February 5, 2026, at 5 for me.** Please go ahead and lock that in as our working session time. With you as the "Senior Executive" for this project, we can stay aligned, realistic, and moving i

I think we can discuss the following in that meeting:

- Confirm scope boundaries and success criteria (Build vs Buy decision lens)
- Walk everyone through Simon's feature list and identify the 4-bucket mapping of what are...
 - a) Already in ChMeetings
 - b) Configurable in ChMeetings
 - c) Extend via integration (ex, Mailchimp)
 - d) Truly unique District needs (may require additional tooling)
- Identify 1 MVP deliverable for Sprint 1 (2 to 4 weeks)
- Assign owners and next steps (including documentation and onboarding plan)
- I hope that we will have a one-page Project Charter draft (goals, non-goals, success metrics) at the end of this Zoom meeting.

This is what everyone can do before our Feb 5 session, so the meeting is productive:

You can start at <https://chmeetings.com> and their knowledgebase at <https://help.chmeetings.com/hc/en-us> and the current year's release notes at <https://www.chmee> notes are linked at the bottom of that page). I am the current owner of <https://vay.chmeetings.com> (the diocese) version, which contains all the people records that I a notably a "church" that contains all the pastors and workers of the District. But the main reason I use ChMeetings is that under the VAY diocese, I set up our own chu mobile app at <https://rpc.chmeetings.com>

Below is the rough explanation of the multi-tenant setup of Diocese > Church > Ministry > Group. But if you, I, and Peter start collaborating, we can set up a GitHub f the vision further.

Design notes

DIOCESE: VAY

"CHURCH": VN District

"CHURCH": RPC

"CHURCH": VAY-SM

"MINISTRY": Viet Svc

CM Grp

Youth
Grp

Sports Fest
Athletes

ORN

RPC

We are using Diocese version, our Diocese is "Vietnamese Alliance Churches" (all user will be shared in here).
Diocese can have its own Mobile App!
Church can have its own App, Payment system, Admin, etc. (This is why VAY-SM is a church for its own Admin, Payment system, etc. may not be copied across them!)
Ministry can have its own location (such as a site in a multi-site church) – be careful when setting ministries up since they are not groups.
Group is a collection of people, you can import a group of people, but not import a ministry of people, people can be added to a group.
Leaders can accept them to join

Thay Truong, please let us know who will host the Zoom (with recording for later reference) and share the meeting link when ready. If there are any additional attendees, please let us know.

Thanks,
-Bumble

On Tue, Jan 27, 2026 at 7:58 PM T.X. Ho <tx.ho99@gmail.com> wrote:
Hi Pastors Bumble, Peter, and Simon,

This is a beautiful dialogue—thank God for this collaboration.

Since Simon is on Eastern Time, I'm suggesting we meet at 5:00 PM Pacific (8:00 PM Eastern). Please let me know which day works best for a working session:

1. Friday, January 30, 2026
2. Monday, February 2, 2026
3. Thursday, February 5, 2026

If you're available for just one date or two or all three dates at 5:00 PM Pacific, please let me know that as well.

Blessings,
Truong

Sent from my iPhone

On Jan 27, 2026, at 2:55 PM, CoHo redemptionpoint <PastorBumble@gmail.com> wrote:



CoHo redemptionpoint reacted via Gmail

On Tue, Jan 27, 2026 at 1:39 PM Simon Lieu <lieu.thanh.chi@gmail.com> wrote:
Hello Pastor Bumble,
Thank you for the detailed analysis. I'm aligned with the approach you outlined.
I agree that ChMeetings should be treated as the backbone and system of record, and that a clear gap analysis should come before any custom build.
Extending or integrating on top of ChMeetings where there is real District-level value feels like the right path.
I'm happy to help design and build whatever necessary features, workflows, or integrations are needed to support GH in upgrading its management capabilities.
I'm also open to the proposed working session to walk through the feature list together.

Thanks again, and I look forward to collaborating.

Blessings,

Simon Lieu

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Cell: 714-261-3167 | me@simonlieu.com

<https://www.simonlieu.com>

On Tue, Jan 27, 2026 at 1:23 PM CoHo redemptionpoint <pastorbumble@gmail.com> wrote:

Hello Thầy Trưởng, Pastor Peter, and Simon,

Thanks for sending this over. Putting on my "former IT Director" hat for a moment, I see the classic **Build-vs-Buy tension** here.

I really appreciate the vision and the thoughtful feature list. At the same time, my first instinct is: *before we invest time and risk into building a custom pl against what we already have in place*, especially since VAY had already started using ChMeetings (we run a Diocese instance, and our church RP is a to fleshout the implementations as well as the VAY Sports Ministry and VAY Winter Retreat).

Below is a quick pass, mapping Simon's feature list to what ChMeetings already provides today, what we can integrate or extend on top of it, and what beyond ChMeetings.

A. What ChMeetings already does (mapping to Simon's list)

1. Core system architecture (multi-tenant, subdomains, data isolation)
 - This is essentially what the Diocese model is designed for: one umbrella environment with multiple churches underneath it, each with its own cor member portal and app experience.
2. Users, roles, permissions
 - ChMeetings already has role-based access for backend users (admins, group leaders, etc.) plus separate member permissions for what membe
3. Member and family management
 - People profiles, family/household structures, status and segmentation, communication history, imports/exports, and reporting are all core strengt
4. Groups, classes, ministries
 - Groups and ministries are first-class modules, with leader assignment, scheduling, group communication, and member interaction.
5. Content management (announcements, articles, sermons/media)
 - ChMeetings has a Member Portal Builder (content pages/cards), plus blogging and media library capabilities (especially with the branded app), v "publish/schedule/visibility" needs in the proposal.
6. Prayer system
 - I did not see a dedicated "prayer module" in the same way the proposal describes, but functionally we can accomplish most of it through forms (i restrictions) plus workflows: auto-notifications to the right people, follow-ups, and publishing selected items in the portal as appropriate.
7. Communication tools (email, segmentation, templates, scheduling, audit/history)
 - ChMeetings has built-in email (including scheduling and templates via the Email Designer), plus SMS and push notifications. It also has commur cover a lot of the "audit trail" concerns.
8. Website and member portal
 - ChMeetings is not trying to replace a full public website CMS, but it does provide a member portal/app experience and ways to integrate with an elements, portal pages, etc.).
9. Security and data management
 - There are built-in log reports (access logs, people logs) and data export options. Also, Diocese accounts can be provisioned with enterprise-leve
10. Platform administration
 - The Diocese structure already gives the District a centralized way to organize churches under one umbrella while keeping each church's operati

Also, the "future phase" items you listed (attendance tracking, online giving, volunteer scheduling, event registration, calendar integration) are largely al depending on the plan and configuration.

B. What we can integrate or build on top of ChMeetings (instead of rebuilding core systems)

If we agree that ChMeetings should be the system of record, then we can extend it in a lower-risk way:

- 1) Mailchimp for newsletters and marketing automation
 - Since you already plan to use Mailchimp, we can take advantage of the existing ChMeetings-Mailchimp integration rather than maintaining our o more maintainable than building or operating our own mailing infrastructure.
- 2) API + webhooks for District-specific needs
 - ChMeetings provides an API and webhooks that can push key events (people updates, contributions, etc.) into a District-level data store, dashbo
 - This is where we can do District-wide reporting, cross-church dashboards, committee workflows, and specialized processes without duplicating t
- 3) Website integration rather than website replacement
 - We can keep a normal District website (WordPress, etc.) and embed or link to the ChMeetings-powered portal, forms, events, and registrations :
- 4) Payments and messaging
 - ChMeetings already integrates with major payment and SMS providers. We can standardize on those rails instead of owning PCI risk and mess:

C. What might be truly unique and require something beyond ChMeetings

This is the part I think we should isolate carefully, because it is where a custom solution might be justified (but not necessarily "build our own platform"):

- District governance workflows that require multi-step approvals across committees (ordination packets, licensing, annual reporting, credential re
- A District-wide "single workflow" that spans multiple churches, where each church should only see its slice, but District leadership needs an aggr
- Specialized data fields and reporting that go beyond what is practical to do purely inside ChMeetings screens (even if the underlying data still liv

Even then, my bias would be: solve these with a thin layer on top of ChMeetings (workflow tool, document management, dashboards) rather than recreating the wheel.

D. Benefits of collaborating around the ChMeetings foundation

If we align on ChMeetings as the backbone, we get:

- Faster time to value: we can pilot in weeks, not months.
- Lower operational risk: security, uptime, backups, vendor maintenance, and feature roadmap are handled.
- Less fragmentation: one system of record for people, groups, events, giving, and communications.
- Easier adoption: our pastors and churches are already using it (and RP is actively running on it).
- More scalable collaboration: we can standardize District-wide templates (forms, workflows, reporting patterns) while letting each church contextualize.

Next step suggestion

I would love for Simon and you to see ChMeetings in a realistic environment before we go too far down the custom path.

Two easy options:

1. Simon/you can request a demo instance directly from ChMeetings, with full admin access for evaluation.
2. Or I can provision a sandbox church inside our VAY Diocese, give you admin permissions, and we can walk through the modules together using the demo.

If you are open to it, I propose a 60–90 minute working session where we:

- Walk feature-by-feature through Simon's list
- Label each item: "Already in ChMeetings", "Configurable in ChMeetings", "Integrate on top", or "Truly custom."
- End with a phased recommendation and a realistic effort estimate

Thanks again for moving this forward. I am for the vision. I just want us to be wise and leverage what we already have before we take on the long-term.

Warmly,
-Bumble
Admin, VAY Diocese (vay.ChMeetings.com)
Redemption Point Church (rpc.chmeetings.com)

PS: I appreciate that Simon included a budget and a phased timeline. That said, the timeline and operating cost assumptions feel optimistic when we create a multi-tenant system with privacy controls, audit logs, on-call support, security patching, backups, and data governance. For example, the budget overview for a 12-month pilot, the higher cost and risk is not hosting. It is:

- Engineering time (build, test, iterate, fix)
- Long-term maintenance and support
- Security and incident response responsibility
- Training and adoption support across churches

Those are all doable, but they require a clear ownership model (who supports it, who is on call, what happens if the primary developer is unavailable, where I think a coordinated and collaboration on how to leverage an existing system across churches in the District would be the best value proposition.

On Fri, Jan 23, 2026 at 7:22 PM T.X. Ho <tx.ho99@gmail.com> wrote:

Dear Pastor Bumble and Pastor Peter,

Anh Lieu Thành Chí, who has been supporting our district with the HD Registration App, has identified a broader need among our churches - a simplified registration system that can be leveraged across all churches. He proposed a potential solution to address it.

Since both of you have been using **CHMeetings** and are currently developing a pastors' directory leveraging this platform, you have a strong understanding of a typical local church. We would greatly value your perspective and would appreciate it if you could review Chi's **general description of the proposed solution**.

Because this would be a **custom-built solution**, Chi can tailor the application to meet our specific requirements. The intent is to make this platform a long-term solution. If the majority of churches can leverage a common platform, it will significantly simplify data sharing and long-term maintenance.

You can also find additional specifications [here](#) for your reference.

Thank you in advance for your time, insight, and guidance. Your feedback will be very helpful as we discern next steps. Feel free to ask questions via email or set up a Zoom session for us to chat.

Blessings,
Truong

----- Forwarded message -----
From: **Simon Lieu** <lieu.thanh.chi@gmail.com>
Date: Wed, Dec 31, 2025 at 6:28 AM
Subject: Vision & Feature Overview: CM&A Church Management System
To: T.X. Ho <tx.ho99@gmail.com>

Good morning chu Truong,

I would like to share a clear vision and feature I've been dreaming of for our Churches Management System and hope for changes in the new year coming.

Below is outline for a Church Management System (ChMS) I am planning to build specifically for CM&A churches if I can get approve in near future.

Overall Vision

The goal is to create a centralized yet independent system where each CM&A church has its own secure environment, while sharing a common platform subdomain (e.g., churchname.maindomain.com) with full autonomy over its data, members, and content.

1. Core System Architecture

- Multi-tenant system with subdomain-based access per church
- Complete data isolation per church
- Church profile with name, logo, address, timezone, and language settings
- Ability to enable or disable features per church

2. Users, Roles, and Permissions

- Platform Super Admin (system owner)
- Church Admin (full control of their church)
- Editor (create, edit, and delete articles, blogs, sermons, and announcements)

- Member (member portal access)

Role-based permissions will control access to content, members, communication, and church modules.

3. Member and Family Management

- Individual member profiles (name, contact info, date of birth, membership status, notes)
- Family grouping with shared contact information
- Support for individual-based or family-based communication
- Member import (CSV) and status tracking

4. Groups, Classes, and Ministries

- Small groups, cell groups, and ministry teams
- Group leaders and schedules
- Classes such as Sunday School, baptism, and membership classes
- Attendance tracking (optional for later phases)
- Group-specific announcements and communication

5. Content Management

- Announcements and weekly updates
- Articles and blog posts
- Sermons with audio uploads or video links
- Drafting, scheduling, and publishing workflow
- Visibility control (public, members-only, leaders-only)

6. Prayer System

- Prayer request submission (public, private, group-only, anonymous)
- Weekly prayer updates and testimonies
- Prayer request status (new, ongoing, answered)
- Moderation and approval controls

7. Communication Tools

- Email communication system with church branding
- Email templates and scheduling
- Sending to all members, families, groups, or classes
- Email history and audit logs
- Unsubscribe and consent management

8. Church Website & Member Portal

- Public-facing church website under each subdomain
- Pages such as Home, About, Beliefs, Leadership, Sermons, Events, and Contact
- Member login portal for announcements, prayer requests, group information, and profile updates

9. Security and Data Management

- Role-based access control
- Audit logs for changes
- Soft deletes for sensitive records
- Data export and backup capability per church

10. Platform Administration

- Church onboarding and management dashboard
- Usage metrics (members, storage, email usage)
- Ability to suspend or manage churches centrally
- Global announcements from platform admin

Future (Planned but Not Required for Initial Release)

- Attendance tracking
- Online giving and donation tracking
- Volunteer scheduling

- Event registration
- Calendar integration

This system is intended to provide a solid, scalable foundation that meets the real operational needs of CM&A churches while remaining flexible for fi

Thank you for taking the time to review this vision. I welcome any feedback, suggestions.
Have a blessed new year 2026,

Simon Lieu

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Cell: 714-261-3167 | me@simonlieu.com
<https://www.simonlieu.com>